

SECTION 1: OFFICIAL TOURNAMENT STAGES & HOURLY SCHEDULE

STAGE 0 · 08:00 - 09:00 Team Check-in, Desk Verification & Credentials Distribution Registration verification at Helpdesk. Distribution of official Team IDs and system credentials. Teams occupy designated terminal stations and verify environment setup (AI IDE, Git, Public GitHub connection).	PRE-EVENT SETUP
STAGE 1 · 09:00 - 12:15 Round 1 Commences: Track Allocation & Architecture Prototyping Official track problem statements unlocked on dashboard. Teams formulate optimization pipelines, design algorithms (GA, PSO, ACO, Fuzzy Logic), build modular components, and push code to single-branch public repo.	CORE HACKING · 3h 15m
STAGE 2 · 12:15 - 12:30 Attempt 1 Online Submission Window for Automated AI Evaluation Portal opens for Attempt 1. Automated multi-metric evaluator executes code validation, AST design checks, efficiency profiling, and baseline convergence benchmarks. Immediate live scores reflected on dashboard.	SUBMISSION 1 · STRICT DEADLINE
STAGE 3 · 12:30 - 13:15 Networking & Lunch Break (Leaderboard Insights) Official lunch break. System displays midway preliminary leaderboard. Teams analyze Attempt 1 feedback diagnostics, rubric suggestions, and plan algorithmic tuning for Stage 4.	BREAK & STRATEGY · 45m
STAGE 4 · 13:15 - 14:45 Round 2 Commences: Perturbation Shifts & Live Patching Surprise perturbation scenarios activated (demographic drift, sensor noise, corridor blockade). Teams must adapt their models and hyper-parameters dynamically to handle unexpected stress-testing vectors.	LIVE STRESS ROUND · 1h 30m
STAGE 5 · 14:45 - 15:00 Attempt 2 & 3 Final Submissions Window Final window for Attempt 2 and Attempt 3. Strict 15:00 cut-off. Code freeze enforced across all repositories. Best valid attempt score is locked for automated scoring (60% overall weight).	FINAL CODE FREEZE · STRICT
STAGE 6 · 15:00 - 16:00 Expert Panel Jury Evaluation & Viva-Voce Defense Domain judges and technical jury visit teams or conduct oral defense. 4-minute presentation per team covering: mathematical justification, architectural innovation, real-world viability, and QA (40% weight).	EXPERT JURY EVALUATION · 1h
STAGE 7 · 16:00 - 17:00 Leaderboard Unfreezing, Valedictory & Awards Ceremony Combined 60% Auto + 40% Jury scores computed. Unfreezing of final leaderboard. Keynote remarks by organizers, felicitation of winning teams, trophy presentation, and distribution of official IEEE certificates.	VALEDICTORY & PRIZE AWARDS

SECTION 2: STEP-BY-STEP PARTICIPANT WORKFLOW (HOW TO WORK & SUBMIT)

01 Prerequisites & Environment Setup

- Ensure your AI IDE (Antigravity, Cursor, VS Code) is installed with Python 3.10+ runtime.
- Verify Git configuration with your active GitHub account credentials.
- Ensure you have received your official Team ID (OPT-26-XXXX) from desk or directory.

02 Repository Initialization & Single Branch Rule

- Create a brand new repository on GitHub and set visibility to strictly PUBLIC.
- Keep all commits strictly within a SINGLE branch (e.g., 'main'). No multi-branch confusion.
- Total repository size must remain strictly under 10 MB (exclude huge datasets / artifacts).

03 Prompting, Development & Clean Architecture

- Clone your repository inside your AI platform and begin iterative development.
- Follow clean coding practices: modular functions, type hints, proper error boundaries.
- Commit progress regularly to demonstrate progressive development and transparent authorship.

04 What to Submit & Documentation (README.md)

- Public GitHub repository URL entered into the OptiForge portal.
- Complete source code inside repository, executable and self-contained.
- Mandatory README.md detailing: Chosen Vertical, Mathematical Approach, Assumptions, and Setup.

05 Online AI Evaluation & Progressive Attempts (Max 3)

- Submit URL in portal during submission windows (Stage 2 and Stage 5).
- Max 3 attempts allowed. Automated pipeline clones, parses AST, runs stress tests, and grades.
- Detailed feedback and scores are instantly displayed. Your highest scored attempt is retained.

06 Jury Defense & Master Leaderboard Freeze

- During Stage 6, present your architecture and live demo to the assigned Domain Expert Jury.
- Score synthesis: 60% Auto AI Evaluation Score + 40% Expert Panel Jury Score.
- Top teams awarded trophies, IEEE certificates, and fast-track recognition.

SECTION 3: SCORING SYNTHESIS & STRICT SUBMISSION RULES

EVALUATION WEIGHT MATRIX

Automated AI Evaluation Engine:	60%
Code AST, Convergence, Benchmarks, Stress tests	
Expert Technical Panel Jury:	40%
Oral defense, mathematical rigor, domain novelty	
High Impact Focus:	Crucial
Solution quality, robustness under noise, correct output	
Medium / Low Impact Focus:	Fine-tune
Code cleanliness, efficiency SLA, README documentation	

GOLDEN RULES & ZERO-TOLERANCE POLICIES

1. Strict 3 Attempt Ceiling: Attempt 4 is blocked by system.
2. Public Single-Branch Repo: Private or multi-branch disqualified.
3. Max 10 MB Size: Do not commit large binary weights or dumps.
4. AI-Plagiarism & Hardcoding Guard: AST checks detect dummy scores.
5. Live Patch Mandatory: Must handle Stage 4 unannounced shifts.